

Bundles of Trouble

There was a woman who felt that life was **cruel** to her. She worked harder than most people, but while **rewards** remained **elusive**, problems came **thick and fast**. No sooner had she solved one problem than another would **loom on the horizon**.

One night she felt so defeated that she cried herself to sleep. Presently, she had a dream. She found herself in a **dimly lit cavern** that was full of grey bundles of various shapes and sizes. A woman with long, flowing white hair came forward to meet her.

"You're in the **Cave** of Bundles of Troubles," she explained, "and I am the Keeper. Here you may exchange the Bundle of Trouble you're carrying on your left shoulder for any of these others."

The dreamer looked, and saw that she did **indeed** have such a bundle.

"No wonder I've been having so many problems!" she thought. "It's so large!!"

She quickly put it down, and began to look for a replacement. Her task took hours. She didn't feel comfortable with any of the bundles she picked up. Finally she found one that **seemed** just right for her.

"I'll take this one!" she said, happily.

"All right," said the Keeper, "if you look carefully you'll see it's the same bundle you came in with. But do not **despair**. All of us carry another bundle on our right shoulder. Yours will help you **bear** the load on your left."

The woman looked and saw that there was indeed another bundle on her right shoulder. It was **woven** of silver and gold threads, and **shone** with the brilliance of a diamond.

"Open it," advised the Keeper.

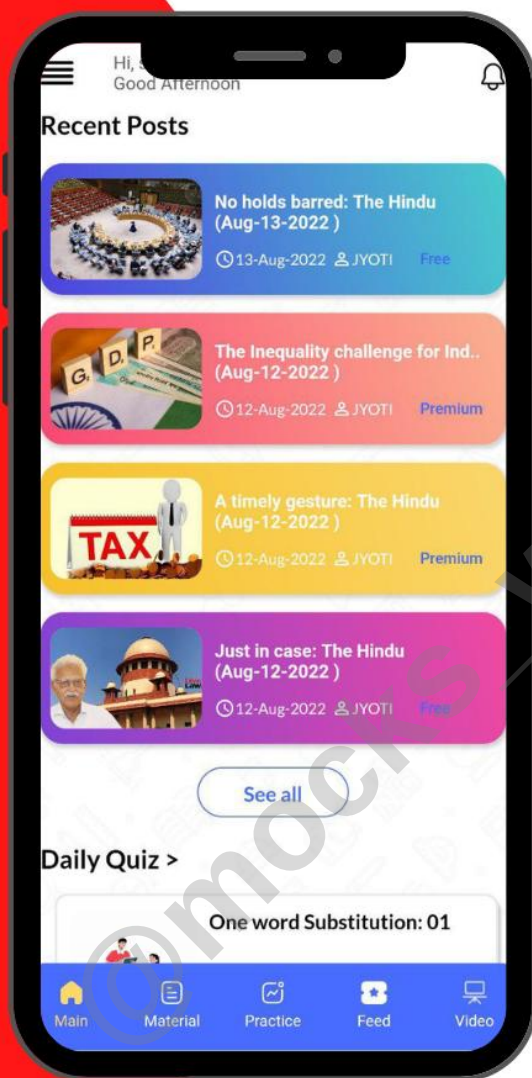
The woman opened it, and there inside **lay** her experiences and her sweetest memories. They glittered like precious gems. **Nestled** inside, were also her talents and abilities, her hopes and all the opportunities that were yet to come. The dreamer's heart was filled with joy. She looked up to thank the Keeper but she was gone. The cave and the bundles too had disappeared.

She **awoke** to find sunlight **streaming** onto her face. It was morning.



Vocabulary

1. **Cruel** (adjective) – harsh, unkind, brutal, heartless, ruthless क्रूर
2. **Reward** (noun) – prize, compensation, return, award, benefit इनाम
3. **Elusive** (adjective) – evasive, slippery, intangible, obscure, mysterious कठिन से पकड़ में आने वाला
4. **Thick and fast** (phrase) – rapidly, swiftly, abundantly, incessantly, overwhelmingly तेजी से और लगातार
5. **Loom** (verb) – emerge, appear, threaten, approach, hover मंडराना
6. **On the horizon** (phrase) – impending, upcoming, approaching, foreseeable, near आसन्न
7. **Dimly** (adverb) – faintly, weakly, obscurely, poorly, indistinctly धुंधलेपन से
8. **Lit** (adjective) – illuminated, lighted, glowing, bright, radiant प्रकाशित
9. **Cavern** (noun) – cave, hollow, grotto, chamber, cavity गुफा
10. **Cave** (noun) – cavern, hollow, den, grotto, tunnel गुफा
11. **Indeed** (adverb) – truly, certainly, actually, surely, undoubtedly वास्तव में
12. **Seem** (verb) – appear, look, resemble, suggest, give the impression लगना
13. **Despair** (noun) – hopelessness, gloom, misery, depression, desperation निराशा
14. **Bear** (verb) – endure, carry, tolerate, support, shoulder सहन करना
15. **Weave** (verb) – knit, braid, entwine, interlace, twist बुनना
16. **Shine** (verb) – sparkle, glow, gleam, radiate, glitter चमकना
17. **Lay** (verb) – place, set, put, position, deposit रखना
18. **Nestle** (verb) – snuggle, cuddle, rest, fit, settle सिमटना
19. **Awake** (verb) – arise, wake, rouse, stir, get up जागना
20. **Stream** (verb) – pour, flow, gush, spurt, run बहना



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